

MARA JORGENSEN

AI Strategy & Technical Transformation Leader | Commodity Trading & AgTech

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Summary

Senior technical executive with 20+ years of experience bridging business strategy and engineering across commodities trading, risk management, and logistics. Deep hands-on expertise with physical and financial trading platforms spanning agricultural and chemical commodities, including operations, hedging, and end-to-end logistics workflows. Proven leader in the early adoption of agentic AI and LLM-based orchestration, driving pilots from discovery through production with disciplined governance, compliance, and change management. Trusted executive advisor known for translating complex technical problems into clear, prioritized roadmaps. Adept at leading platform initiatives and driving measurable revenue growth and operational efficiency across trading and operations teams.

Skills

AI Product Strategy & Leadership

- AI Roadmapping
- Agentic workflows
- LLM orchestration
- RAG strategy
- Rapid pilot-to-production cycles
- Predictive analytics
- Python-based ML workflows
- Responsible AI posture & governance
- Compliance considerations & integration
- Human-in-the-loop safeguards

Executive Technical Leadership

- Executive stakeholder management
- Multi-year roadmaps & strategic planning
- Cross-functional team leadership
- "Build vs. buy" economic analysis
- Change management & user adoption
- Agile methodologies & OKR frameworks

Industry & Tools Expertise

- **Commodities & Trading:** Agriculture, chemicals, gas, metals, chemicals, plastics, grains, paper, bulk logistics systems, ETRM/CTRM platforms (Ion, Right Angle, Allegro, custom), Procure-to-pay & order-to-cash optimization, ERP systems (SAP, Oracle, JDE, Dynamics, Agris)
- **Modern Techn Stack:** Agents, workflows, Azure AI Foundry, n8n, OpenAI/ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, Cursor, v0, Bolt, Azure AI Foundry, OpenAI, Claude, n8n
- **Data, Integration, & Infrastructure Expertise:** Data pipelines, Python, SQL, APIs, iPaaS, ETL, Data Warehousing, Knowledge Retrieval (RAG), Vector Database Strategy, Data Stubbing & Feasibility Testing, Legacy system modernization, Power BI

Professional Experience

AI Strategy & Technical Transformation Leader/CEO at Strategic Consulting Corp. | 2020 – Present

Specialized consultancy for AI implementation & enterprise digital transformation in agriculture and commodities

- **Executive Advisory & AI Strategy:** Consults with executives (CTOs, CIOs, VPs of Logistics) to identify AI use cases, translate business requirements into technical specifications, and lead "build vs. buy" analyses for AI and enterprise system selection
- **90-Day AI Accelerator Framework:** Developed and executes a 3-phase methodology to identify high-value AI opportunities, build functional prototypes, and establish 6–12-month production roadmaps for enterprise clients in agriculture, insurance, and commodities sectors
- **Agentic AI Implementation:** Architects and deploy predictive AI engines and agentic workflows using Azure AI Foundry, OpenAI, n8n, and Python, driving pilot-to-production cycles for process automation in trading, logistics, and operations
- **Technical Leadership:** Leads as technical advocate, representing data and engineering needs in executive forums, while coaching development teams on modern AI-assisted engineering workflows and best practices
- **Digital Transformation Roadmaps:** Spearheads multi-year product roadmaps integrating AI/ML, legacy system modernization, and enterprise platform strategy

Head of Freight Product & Customer Operations at Kontango | 2023-2024

Market intelligence platform for chemical commodity traders

- **Product Leadership:** Directed end-to-end product roadmap for a data-intensive freight platform, integrating new predictive ML models for freight costing and rate optimization that accelerated customer adoption and improved pricing accuracy
- **Executive Leadership:** Served as primary customer-facing technical advisor to CXO-level stakeholders, driving engagement by translating complex technical capabilities into business value and ROI
- **Head of Customer Operation:** Owned end-to-end customer operations including onboarding processes, customer success programs, and support escalations for enterprise commodity trading and logistics clients

- **MVP Definition & Roadmap Execution:** Led discovery research, A/B testing, and customer journey mapping to define MVP features and prioritize backlog, maximizing ROI for key accounts while managing P&L and technical delivery timelines
- **CRM & Integration Strategy:** Spearheaded all CRM efforts including data mapping, system integration design, and requirements definition, partnering with CEO and business stakeholders to align commercial and technical objectives

General Manager/Product [Integrations & Compliance] at Roger | 2020-2023

Agriculture & commodity logistics technology platform

- **Platform Launch & P&L Ownership:** Led design and launch of onRamp, a secure carrier onboarding platform for insurance, FMCSA, and hauling contracts. Increased platform revenue by ~20% in under 12 months through strategic customer acquisition
- **Enterprise Integration Leadership:** Directed integrations engineering for B2B partnerships, conducting full market analysis, source/target system requirements, and API design, including FMCSA integration and implementations with five of North America's largest agriculture shippers
- **Executive Product Leadership:** Managed two product groups, aligning roadmaps with organizational strategy while conducting regular business reviews with C-suite executives from top-tier agriculture and logistics clients
- **Cross-Functional Management:** Led cross-functional teams of onshore/offshore engineers, designers, and legal partners through full product lifecycle, from discovery and design sprints to release planning and UAT
- **Customer/Business Advocate:** Ran iterative discovery and dev cycles with agriculture business stakeholders, translating user needs into detailed product requirements and user stories that drove measurable improvements in UX and engagement

Principal Consultant, Business Solutions at Fast Solutions | 2013-2020

ERP and enterprise systems consulting firm specializing in agriculture and commodities

- **ERP & CTRM Implementation Leadership:** Led product and engineering teams through complex ERP, CTRM and ETRM integrations for agriculture and commodity trading clients, managing full implementation lifecycle from requirements through go-live
- **Commodities Domain Expert:** Served as primary technical liaison for commodity trading, risk management, hedging, logistics, and settlement operations, specializing in risk analysis, trading desk workflows, procure-to-pay, and order-to-cash optimization
- **Digital Transformation Strategy:** Drove enterprise digital transformation by creating multi-year product roadmaps for legacy system modernization across chemical manufacturing, ag trading, and logistics organizations
- **Transportation Management Leadership:** Advised on and implemented TMS solutions, designing user-centric software for large agricultural clients managing bulk logistics, low-connectivity field operations, and complex supply chain requirements
- **Pre-Sales & Solution Design:** Led complex pre-sales analysis and solution architecture for major system implementations, translating business stakeholder needs into technical specifications and implementation plans

Software Engineer & Business Analyst at Tyson Foods | 2010-2013

Fortune 100 agriculture manufacturing and distribution company

- **Business-Technical Liaison:** Acted as key liaison between business stakeholders (sales, manufacturing, procurement, logistics) and IT, translating requirements for modern systems integration with legacy ERP and mainframe platforms
- **Integration Architecture:** Designed and developed integrations that enhanced data flow between critical business systems in a highly regulated food manufacturing and distribution environment
- **Reporting & Analytics:** Built reporting platforms to support operational decision-making across supply chains, procurement, and logistics functions

Software Engineer & Security at CF Industries | 2001-2010

Leading agricultural chemical manufacturer

- **Agricultural Systems:** Engineered robust software solutions and SAP integrations, building foundational experience in complex system architecture
- **SOX Compliance Leadership:** Led risk analysis, remediation, and mitigation efforts for Sarbanes-Oxley compliance across enterprise systems

Education

Masters in Management | Bellevue University, Bellevue, Nebraska

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Mathematics | Morningside University, Sioux City, Iowa